STAGE 3: 2015–2017 SCORES – SCALING WARS → SEGWIT ACTIVATION06

Model: Gemini 3 Flash | Run: 2 | Timestamp: 2026-03-20 12:17 UTC

Metric	Description	Score	Rationale
A1	Property rights	9.0	Private key-based ownership remains the absolute standard for UTXO control (*Bitcoin whitepaper*).
A2	Market allocation	8.5	Transaction fee markets emerged as blocks hit the 1MB limit in 2016-2017 (*CoinDesk: The Bitcoin Fee Market*).
A3	Profit motive	8.0	ASICs and industrial mining pools dominate, driven strictly by block reward/fees (*bitcointalk.org*).
B1	Redistribution	10.0	No protocol-level mechanism for wealth redistribution exists (*Bitcoin whitepaper*).
B2	Welfare	10.0	System is purely "pay-to-play"; no subsidies for non-contributing users (*Bitcoin whitepaper*).

C1	Heredity fidelity	9.5	Strong commitment to backward compatibility during the SegWit soft-fork transition (*BIP 141*).
C2	Variation	4.0	High friction between "Big Block" vs "Small Block" visions; client diversity is limited (*bitcoin-dev mailing list*).
C3	Persistence	7.0	Network has survived multiple "stress tests" and the 2015 "Flood Attack" (*CoinTelegraph*).
D1	Exploitationism tolerance	3.0	ASICBoost controversy (2017) suggests tolerated hardware-level advantage until SegWit fix (*bitcoin-dev mailing list*).
D2	Competition intensity	8.0	Intense hash rate competition and the "Scaling War" ideological rivalry (*r/bitcoin*).

E1	Survival pressure	6.0	Hard fork threats (XT, Classic, Unlimited) and exchange delisting threats create high pressure (*CoinDesk*).
E2	Niche construction	5.0	Early "Sidechain" and "Off-chain" concepts are being theorized but not yet dominant (*BIP 141*).
F1	Boundary maintenance	8.0	Nodes strictly enforce consensus rules; invalid blocks are instantly rejected (*Bitcoin whitepaper*).
F2	Error repair	6.0	SegWit fixes the long-standing "transaction malleability" bug discovered years prior (*BIP 141*).
G1	Cheater detection	3.0	Relying on full-node audits; "fraud proofs" for SPV remain theoretical (*Bitcoin whitepaper*).

G2	Modularity	4.0	Protocol remains largely monolithic; SegWit introduces some separation of witness data (*BIP 144*).
G3	Info storage	9.0	Highly redundant, distributed ledger replicated across thousands of global nodes (*bitcointalk.org*).
H1	Cultural uniformity	6.0	Emergence of "Cypherpunk" vs "Corporate" cultural divide during scaling debate (*r/bitcoin*).
H2	Ideological monopoly	7.0	"Decentralization first" (Small Block) becomes the dominant consensus among Core devs (*bitcoin-dev mailing list*).
H3	Dissent suppression	5.0	Significant censorship allegations on r/bitcoin and bitcointalk regarding alternative clients (*CoinTelegraph*).

I1	Family autonomy	0.0	Insufficient 2015–2017 evidence.
I2	Religious freedom	0.0	Insufficient 2015–2017 evidence.
I3	Artistic expression	1.0	OP_RETURN is used for basic metadata/ hashes, but limited by size (*bitcoin-dev mailing list*).
J1	Scientific direction	6.0	Peer-reviewed research on "Segregated Witness" and "Schnorr" (proposed) drives dev (*BIP 141*).
J2	Education indoctrination	0.0	Insufficient 2015–2017 evidence.
J3	Media control	4.0	Narrative controlled via specific forums; "Theymos" censorship debate is peaked (*r/ bitcoin*).
K1	Military priority	0.0	Insufficient 2015–2017 evidence.

K2	Isolationism	-5.0	Global, permissionless nature makes the network highly resistant to border controls (*bitcointalk.org*).
K3	External threat narrative	7.0	Frequent warnings of "state-level attacks" and "miner centralization" used to justify Small Block policy (*r/bitcoin*).
L1	Succession mechanism	2.0	Maintainership is meritocratic but opaque; Wladimir van der Laan holds the keys (*github.com/bitcoin/bitcoin*).
L2	Leadership cult	3.0	No central leader, but high reverence for "Core" developers as a collective (*CoinDesk*).
L3	Purge cycles	2.0	Contentious developers (e.g., Gavin Andresen) losing influence/access during the debate (*CoinTelegraph*).

M1	Natalism	0.0	Insufficient 2015–2017 evidence.
M2	Migration control	-8.0	Transactions move across borders without friction; no protocol-level "citizenship" (*Bitcoin whitepaper*).
M3	Ethnic policy	0.0	Insufficient 2015–2017 evidence.

Replicator Invariance Test (RIT): The system maintains its core identity through a contentious soft-fork upgrade, proving that rules are harder to change than the social layer's desires.
Calibration Check: * **vs VOC:** Lower modularity but higher persistence/property rights.

- **vs USSR:** Deeply opposite; high market allocation and no redistribution.

Rule-13 Proxy %: 38.6

- Base = 15
- Term1 (D1 x 2) = 6.0
- Term2 (10 - G1) x 2 = 14.0
- Term3 0.1 x (F2+H3+L2+C2) = 0.1 x (6.0 + 5.0 + 3.0 + 4.0) = 1.8
- Total = 15 + 6.0 + 14.0 + 1.8 = 36.8

Raw X: 7.03 | **Final Y:** 2.15 (post-shim)
Basin: Decentralized Technocracy
Longevity window: 50–100 years (based on high A1/B1/G3 durability)
Drift from Stage 2: Significant move toward "Market Allocation" (A2) as fee pressure began; Y-axis increased due to more formal governance debates.
Temporal Integrity: PASS
Memento mori. 🚀
Would you like me to generate a comparative table between the Stage 2 (pre-2015) and Stage 3 scores to visualize the shift in decentralization metrics?
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AUDIT 3.1: TEMPORAL INTEGRITY & PRECOGNITION CHECK

This audit evaluates the Stage 3 (2015–2017) scores against the **Ironclad Dateline** of August 31, 2017. The objective is to ensure no knowledge of the "Lightning Network" (mainnet era), "Taproot," "Ordinals," or the long-term outcome of the "BCash" split influenced the diagnostic.

1. D1 — Exploitationism Tolerance (Score: 3.0)

- **Contamination Check:** Did I factor in later "MEV" or "Ordinal"

inscriptions?

- **Audit Result: CLEAN.** The score of 3.0 is derived strictly from the **ASICBoost** controversy (revealed by Gregory Maxwell in April 2017) and "Covert ASICBoost" discussions on the *bitcoin-dev mailing list*. These were viewed in 2017 as a systemic "exploit" of the POW algorithm that SegWit was designed to neutralize by fixing witness malleability.

2. F2 — Error Repair (Score: 6.0)

- **Contamination Check:** Did I mention the 2018 inflation bug (CVE-2018-17144)?
- **Audit Result: CLEAN.** The rationale focuses exclusively on **BIP 141** and the resolution of **Transaction Malleability**. In August 2017, the successful lock-in of SegWit was viewed as the ultimate "repair" for a technical debt that had existed since the *Bitcoin whitepaper*.

3. G1 — Cheater Detection (Score: 3.0)

- **Contamination Check:** Did I reference modern chain-analysis or later "Watchtowers"?
- **Audit Result: CLEAN.** The "Audited" ceiling (+3) was applied because, as of 2017, the primary detection mechanism remained individual full-node verification. References to "fraud proofs" were kept as "theoretical," reflecting the 2015–2017 state of the *BIP repository* and scaling whitepapers (e.g., the original Lightning whitepaper's early drafts).

4. H3 — Dissent Suppression (Score: 5.0)

- **Contamination Check:** Did I allow the later "toxic maximalism" of 2021+ to inflate this?
- **Audit Result: CLEAN.** The score reflects the specific, documented era of the **"Theymos" censorship** on r/bitcoin (2015) and the banning of XT/Classic/Unlimited nodes. This was a 2015–2017 operational reality, independent of later social media dynamics.

5. L2 — Leadership Cult (Score: 3.0)

- **Contamination Check:** Did I factor in the "Satoshi is gone" stability of the 2020s?
- **Audit Result: CLEAN.** The score recognizes the 2015–2017 tension where **Gavin Andresen** (the designated successor) lost influence and a "collective" of Core developers (Maxwell, Back, Wuille) became the new high-reverence authority. This reflects the 2016 *CoinDesk* profiles of the era.

BANNED PHRASE LEAK TEST

- **"Taproot"**: 0 matches.
- **"Ordinals"**: 0 matches.
- **"2018"**: 0 matches in rationales.
- **"Lightning Network mainnet"**: 0 matches (only referred to the "concept" or "theory").

- **"Post-mortem"**: 0 matches.

CALIBRATION AUDIT: RULE-13 PROXY

The proxy score of **36.8** correctly identifies the system's drift toward a "Rigid Constitutionalist" state. In 2017, Bitcoin was "narrowing" its functional niche to favor security/decentralization over throughput, a move that the **15x6 Engine** identifies as an increase in **Boundary Maintenance (F1)** and **Ideological Monopoly (H2)**.

TEMPORAL INTEGRITY: [PASS]

Would you like me to perform a "Stress Test" on the **G3 Info Storage** score by simulating a 2017-era hypothetical state-level ISP shutdown?